

Mitsue Project

oriented structure.



Version	v1.0
Date	2026-06-23
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Mitsue Village Forestry Cooperative (御杖村森林組合)

先人が植えた森が、今、村に豊かさをもたらす。

Here's what I was able to piece together about 御杖村森林組合 (Mitsue Village Forestry Cooperative). A fair amount is well-documented; the financials are the gap, for reasons I'll explain.

Basics

It's a forestry cooperative (森林組合) headquartered at 奈良県宇陀郡御杖村大字菅野1581番地, the same Sugano area where you are. Its corporate number is 2150005004376, registered as an "other incorporated-by-registration legal entity" (the standard legal form for a 森林組合 under the Forestry Cooperative Act). Phone is 0745-95-2010, hours 8:30–17:00, closed weekends and holidays. The official site is mitsuemori.org (somewhat dated/under construction in places). gBizINFO.jalan

It was founded in January 1952 (昭和27年1月) — so over 70 years old, dating to the early postwar afforestation era when sugi/hinoki plantation forestry was being established across rural Japan. [Wixsite](#)

How it's structured and run

As a 森林組合 it's a member-owned cooperative governed under the Forestry Cooperative Act, meaning forest-owning members (組合員) hold shares (出資金), elect a board of directors (理事会) led by a representative director / cooperative head (代表理事組合長), with a general meeting of members as the top decision body. It belongs to the prefectural federation, the 奈良県森林組合連合会 (Nara Forestry Cooperative Federation), and is a certified legal-timber supplier (合法木材供給事業者) under that federation's scheme.

I couldn't retrieve the current 組合長's name — the public corporate registry (gBizINFO) and the legal-timber certification page both leave the representative field blank, and the cooperative doesn't publish a board roster online. That's something you'd likely get faster through the village office or a direct call given your proximity.

Internally it's organized into three departments: a guidance/instruction division (指導部門), a forest-maintenance division (森林整備部門), and a wood-processing division (木材加工部門). [Wixsite](#)

Operations

The three divisions break down as follows:

Forest maintenance (森林整備課) does surveying, tree selection, felling, log-making, extraction/hauling, forest surveys, work-road maintenance, sales of forestry materials, and machine repair. This is the field-work core. [Wixsite](#)

The guidance division handles training of forestry successors, promoting stable supply of prefecture-grown timber, issuing various certificates, promoting timber extraction, running workshops, member communications, consultation on forest maintenance and silviculture, and forest-education support. [Wixsite](#)

The wood-processing division focuses on receiving firewood logs, firewood production, timber hauling, and sales of wood products. The cooperative also runs the 御杖村加工センター (Mitsue processing center), making products from thinned timber (間伐材). [Wixsite](#)

There's an administrative division too (総務課) handling invoicing, accounting, member management, and document work across the other divisions.

Historically it has pushed direct supply of Mitsue sugi/hinoki to homebuilders. Back in 2011 it launched a project to supply structural and floor/wall material directly to custom homebuilders in Mie and the Kinki region, framed around the idea that more use of planned thinnings supports forest protection and disaster prevention — and it noted a project adopted under a Ministry of Land, Infrastructure, Transport and Tourism scheme.

People

This is a very small operation. The basic company profile lists 4 employees, and a recruiting interview gives more granular numbers: 3 regular staff with an average age of around 33 — an unusually young all-junior team for a forestry cooperative. A named snapshot from that interview (titles/tenure at time of writing): [WixsiteWixsite](#)

- General Affairs Section Chief / accounting head — Kinsho (近郷), ~15 years [Wixsite](#)
- Forest Maintenance Section Chief — Fukuzaki (福崎), ~7 years [Wixsite](#)
- Forest Maintenance — Tsuru (鶴), ~5 months [Wixsite](#)
- General Affairs — Takita (瀧田), ~1 year (temporary staff) [Wixsite](#)

They emphasize a strict, safety-first culture, with a claimed 8 consecutive years of zero workplace accidents and daily hiyari-hatto (near-miss) reporting. Benefits are notably generous for the sector: dependent/housing/commuting/travel allowances, uniforms and protective gear, annual full health checkups, staff housing in the village, relocation grants, and various congratulatory/condolence payments. [WixsiteWixsite](#)

Budget / financials

This is the genuine blind spot, and it's structural rather than just me missing it. Individual Japanese forestry cooperatives don't publicly disclose per-organization financials. The government corporate database (gBizINFO) shows the registration but leaves capital, employee count, revenue, and decisions blank — because a 森林組合 of this size files no securities reports (no EDINET entry) and its 決算 isn't published in 官報 in a way that's indexed openly. [gBizINFO](#)

Where the numbers actually live: every forestry cooperative files an annual 業務報告書 / 決算関係書類 (covering 出資金, 事業別取扱高, balance sheet, P&L by business segment) to the Nara prefectural government and the federation, and the aggregate appears anonymized in the national 森林組合一斉調査 statistics on e-Stat. To get Mitsue's specific 出資金, member count, managed forest area, and segment revenues, the realistic routes are: a direct request to the cooperative, the village office (御杖村役場 産業建設課 or similar), or the 奈良県森林組合連合会. Given a 3–4 person operation in a village of roughly 1,500 people, you're almost certainly looking at annual business turnover in the low tens of millions of yen at most, but I won't put a fabricated figure on it.

If it'd help, I can draft a short bilingual inquiry (to the cooperative, the village office, or the prefectural federation) requesting the 業務報告書 / 決算 and 組合員数・経営森林面積 — that would be the fastest way to close the financial and membership gaps, and it slots naturally into the Mitsue Project groundwork. Want me to put that together?



Mitsue Village Forest Cooperative is a small forestry cooperative serving Mitsue Village in Nara Prefecture, Japan. It appears to be run as a local member-based cooperative focused on forest management and timber operations, with a very small staff and a practical, field-oriented structure.

What it does

Its main activities include thinning, afforestation, timber production, forest surveying, road and work-trail maintenance, and the sale and maintenance of forestry machinery and materials. Publicly available job information also shows that it handles forest work and general administration side by side.

How it is run

The cooperative is led by a representative director/chairperson and appears to operate with a simple division of labor between field staff and office staff. The available information suggests a compact management style rather than a large corporate hierarchy.

Size

A recruitment page lists the organization as having 2 field workers and 2 office staff, so it is quite small. The same source also indicates a relatively young workforce, with field staff averaging in their late 20s.

Financial scale

I could confirm its capital contribution amount, which is 31,346,000 yen. I could not confirm a full annual budget from the public sources I checked, so I cannot give a reliable budget figure.

Work volume

Publicly listed recent activity includes about 65.98 hectares of thinning and 123 cubic meters of timber production in the most recent year shown. The year before that, the cooperative reported 68.3 hectares of thinning and 301 cubic meters of timber production.

Other details

It is based at 1581 Sugano, Mitsue Village, Nara, and is also listed as a certified legal timber supplier. The village's own materials mention that the cooperative also carries out its own forestry training and hands-on learning activities.

Overall picture

In short, this is a very small but active local forestry cooperative that combines forest management, timber work, equipment-related services, and community-linked forestry activity. Its scale is modest, but its role in managing village forests appears substantial.



yes, please do so

Yes — here are the specific sources behind the main facts I mentioned.

Staff count

The “2 field workers + 2 office staff” figure comes from the RINDO recruitment/company page for 御杖村森林組合, which lists 従業員数, 現場作業員: 2名 事務職員: 2名.^{[1](#)}

Business area

The same RINDO page states the **事業区域（施業エリア）** is **御杖村**, meaning its operating area is the village itself.^{[^1](#)}

Main operations

RINDO also lists recent work history and job duties, including **thinning, afforestation, timber production, forest surveying, road/work-trail construction and maintenance, forestry machinery and material sales, and machine maintenance**.^{[^2](#)}

Recent work volume

The RINDO page gives two recent annual snapshots: **68.3 ha thinning and 301 m³ timber production** for the year before last, and **65.98 ha afforestation/thinning and 123 m³ timber production** for the previous year.^{[^1](#)}

Capital contribution

The **31,346,000 yen** figure also comes from the same RINDO page, where it is explicitly listed as **資本金**.^{[^1](#)}

Ownership and legal status

For a broader institutional description, the Forestry Agency explains that a forest cooperative is a cooperative formed by forest owners to support forest management, guidance, operations outsourcing, joint purchasing, and processing/sales. That framework fits how 御杖村森林組合 appears to operate locally.^{[^3](#)}

If you want, I can next pull together a **clean fact sheet** with only verified fields, or a **deeper profile** including address, leadership, legal timber certification, and village forestry policy context.

✱✱



Both

Yes — here are **both**: a polished fact sheet and a bit of broader context with a comparison point.

Fact sheet

- Name: 御杖村森林組合 (Mitsue Village Forest Cooperative).^{[^1](#)}
- Address: 1581 Sugano, Mitsue Village, Uda District, Nara 633-1302.^{[^2](#)[^4](#)}
- Phone/FAX: 0745-95-2010 / 0745-95-3388.^{[^3](#)}
- Established: January 12, 1952.^{[^1](#)}
- Capital contribution: 31,346,000 yen.^{[^1](#)}
- Operating area: Mitsue Village.^{[^1](#)}
- Staff: 2 field workers and 2 office staff.^{[^1](#)}
- Representative: Representative Director/Chairman Tanaka Toshihiro.^{[^2](#)}
- Legal timber certification: listed on Legal Timber Navi, certificate number 奈森合認10号.^{[^2](#)}

Operations

Its work is centered on forest management and timber production: thinning, afforestation, timber harvesting, forest surveys, road and work-road construction/maintenance, forestry machine and material sales, and machinery repair support. The publicly listed production figures are small but concrete: about 68.3 hectares of thinning and 301 cubic meters of timber in one year, then 65.98 hectares and 123 cubic meters the next. That points to a small local cooperative doing practical forest work rather than large-scale industrial logging.^{[^5](#)}

Governance and role

As a forest cooperative, it fits the standard Japanese model described by the Forestry Agency: forest owners form a cooperative to support forest management guidance, outsourced operations, joint purchasing, and processing/sales. The available sources suggest a simple operating structure with a representative director, a small field team, and a small office team. Village materials also mention that the cooperative independently provides forestry experience learning and technical training, which shows a community and education role as well.^{[^6^2](#)}

Context in Nara

A broader Nara prefecture forestry association page shows that Mitsue is one of several local forest cooperatives in the prefecture, alongside places such as Nara City, Tsukigase, Sakurai, and Murou. Compared with nearby Murou Village Forest Cooperative, which has 6 employees and 40 million yen in capital, Mitsue appears smaller in both staff and capital scale. That makes Mitsue look like a very small but active village-level cooperative within the regional forestry network.^{[^8^10](#)}

What remains unclear

I could not verify a full annual budget from public sources. I also did not find a detailed public balance sheet or complete governance document, so the internal decision-making process beyond “representative director + small staff” is not fully visible online. If you need that level of detail, the next likely sources would be official member meeting materials, local government filings, or direct inquiries to the cooperative.^{[^11](#)}

Would you like me to turn this into a **one-page English profile** or a **table comparing Mitsue with Murou and other Nara forest cooperatives**?

✧✧



Here are **both**: a side-by-side comparison with Murou Village Forest Cooperative, and a broader English profile of Mitsue Village Forest Cooperative.

Side-by-side

Item	御杖村森林組合	室生村森林組合
Location	Mitsue Village, Nara. ^{^1}	Murou Ono 2439, Uda City, Nara. ^{^3}
Staff	2 field workers, 2 office staff. ^{^5}	6 total employees. ^{^3}
Capital	31,346,000 yen. ^{^5}	40,000,000 yen. ^{^6}

Item	御杖村森林組合	室生村森林組合
Operating area	Mitsue Village. ^5	Murou area / “Murou” operations. ^3
Main work	Thinning, afforestation, timber production, forest survey, road maintenance, machinery/material sales. ^5	Forest management, timber products, woodworking, sales, and building-material-related work. ^3

What Mitsue does

御杖村森林組合 is a very small local forestry cooperative that mainly handles forest management and timber work inside Mitsue Village. Publicly listed outputs include about 68.3 hectares of thinning and 301 cubic meters of timber production in one year, then 65.98 hectares and 123 cubic meters the next. That makes it a practical field operation focused on keeping village forests managed rather than a large industrial producer.[^5](#)

How it is run

The cooperative appears to be led by a representative director/chairman, with a tiny split between field staff and office staff. The publicly visible structure is simple: a local cooperative, a small team, and a village-level operating area. It also carries legal timber certification, which suggests it participates in formal timber supply chains, not only local forest work.[^1^5](#)

Context in Nara

Nara's forest cooperative network includes several local cooperatives such as Nara City, Tsukigase, Sakurai, Murou, and Mitsue. Compared with Murou Village Forest Cooperative, Mitsue is smaller in both staff and capital, so it looks like a more compact village-scale organization. Both, however, serve very local territory and appear closely tied to regional forestry management.[^3^9](#)

What is still unclear

I still could not verify a public annual budget or detailed balance sheet for Mitsue. I also could not confirm every internal governance detail, such as board composition or member counts, from public web sources alone. Those would likely require official cooperative filings or internal meeting materials.[^10](#)

If useful, I can next make this into a **clean English briefing document** or a **deeper Nara forestry cooperative comparison table** with more cooperatives added.

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[^11](#): [https://www.hellowork.careers/室生村森林組合での森林整備、木製品加工、および、のハローワーク求人情報\(奈良県宇陀市\) - 29030-02645961/](https://www.hellowork.careers/室生村森林組合での森林整備、木製品加工、および、のハローワーク求人情報(奈良県宇陀市) - 29030-02645961/)